

Segmentation of Overlapping Speech

Non-Overlapping Interfering Speech

When a speech segment contains non-overlapping speech from other interfering speakers, insert the [other-speech] tag for each instance of interfering speech in the location where it occurs in the transcription, regardless of intelligibility. **Do not transcribe interfering speech word-for-word.**

[other-speech] tags apply only to interfering speech that does not overlap (or minimally overlap) with speech from the main speaker being transcribed.

49. JOHN	▼ Speech	▼ 165.8 - 169.7	⋮		 9/16/22, 10:21 AM
Where'd you go last night? [other-speech] I #uh thought we had plans for the local music festival. [breath]					

Overlapping Interfering Speech

When there is intelligible overlapping speech between two speakers, transcribe the speech of the overlapping speaker in an alternate segment. If there is more than one overlapping speaker, split the audio segment in a way that only two speakers are present. If that is not possible, the transcriptionist may use an [other-speech] tag, only if the overlap is minimal.

Please note, for voiceovers (from narrators, news reporters, translators, etc.), <overlap></overlap> tagging must be used for transcription. The secondary segment should always be of type “Babble”. **DO NOT** use [other-speech].

141. Man1	▼ Speech	▼ 1631.52 - 1638.02	⋮
<overlap>questo è il convento di San Marco a Firenze e come potete vedere</overlap>			
142.			
EnglishNarrator	▼ Babble	▼ 1631.57 - 1637.97	 ⋮
<overlap><lang:English>()</lang:English></overlap>			

In each segment, enclose the portion of the transcribed speech from the main speaker that is overlapped with <overlap></overlap> tags, including necessary punctuation. **DO NOT** break up a word with the overlap tags; if the overlap begins in the middle of a word, place the <overlap> tag **before** it. If the overlap ends in the middle of a word, place the </overlap> tag **after** it.

After adding a set of overlap tags to the main segment, select the “⋮” and select “Alternate Segment” to create the alternate segment. From here, choose the speaker’s name and primary type for the alternate segment. Transcribe the overlapping speech within a set of overlap tags. Please refer to the example below:

36. BRAD	▼ Speech	▼ 110.53 - 114.04	⋮	🎤
<overlap>Where #um</overlap> you know where Star Court Mall really they was.				
JOHN	▼ Speech	▼ 111.02 - 112.07	▶	⋮
<overlap>That's what I heard.</overlap>				

DO NOT place multiple sets of overlap tags within one main segment. The platform will only allow for the creation of one alternate segment per main segment. Having multiple sets of overlap tags within a segment will trigger a validation error.

Adjusting the Alternate Segment: The alternate segment must also be timestamped within a few milliseconds of the speech. Once created, you will need to resize the alternate segment; to do this, please follow the steps below:

1. Select the "⋮" to the right of the start/end time.
2. Select "Resize".
3. Two red arrows will appear on the audio wave, click, and drag each one to resize the segment to only surround the secondary speaker's audio. Once completed, the system will automatically save the change.

The screenshot shows the AppTek interface with an audio waveform at the top. Below the waveform is a control bar with buttons for 'split', 'Merge', 'play/Pause', a volume slider, and a 'Speaker' button. Below the control bar is a list of speech segments. The segment 'JOHN' is highlighted, and its menu icon (three dots) is highlighted with a red box labeled '1'. The dropdown menu is open, showing options: 'Resize' (highlighted with a red box labeled '2'), 'Delete', and 'Alternate Segment'. The audio waveform shows two overlapping segments: 'BRAD' (blue) and 'JOHN' (grey). Red arrows labeled '3' point to the start and end of the 'JOHN' segment on the waveform.

If the speech is unintelligible, it should contain the unintelligible tag (()). If the interfering segment is indistinct chatter, or if the individual speakers in the segment cannot be clearly identified, the segment should be of primary type "Babble".

Transcriptionists should only be focusing on two main speakers at a time in a segment. Should 3 or more individuals be speaking **at the same time**, that segment must have speaker label "MultiSpeaker", and segment type "Babble".

51. Multispeaker	▼ Babble	▼ 170.7 - 176.24	⋮		 9/16/22, 10:24 AM
[other-speech]					

Please note that it is possible for a segment to include non-overlapping or minimally overlapping speech AND a separate duration of significantly overlapping speech. In this case, use the [other-speech] tag for the minimally overlapping speech and create an alternate segment for the overlapping speech. Example:

47. JOHN	▼ Speech	▼ 161.22 - 163.78	⋮		 9/16/22, 10:27 AM
Sorry, something came up. [other-speech] #uh I tried texting you. Did you <overlap>not get my text message that</overlap> I sent around ten <initial>p.m.</initial>?					
BRAD	▼ Speech	▼ 161.27 - 163.73	▶	⋮	10/07/2022, 3:04 PM
<overlap>#uh, I don't think I did. Let me check.</overlap>					

Common Errors

- When the primary AND the secondary segment are both unintelligible and transcribed only as (()) (see image below), **DO NOT** create an alternate segment. Change the speaker label to “MultiSpeaker” and set the segment type as “Babble” (see second image below).

Incorrect

55. BRAD	▼ Speech	▼ 194.38 - 3779.5	⋮		
<overlap>(<overlapped content>)</overlap>					
JOHN	▼ Speech	▼ 194.43 - 3779.45	▶	⋮	
<overlap>(<overlapped content>)</overlap>					

Correct

51. Multispeaker	▼ Babble	▼ 170.7 - 176.24	⋮		
[other-speech]					

- When the primary speaker is overlapped by [noise], [laugh], [cough] etc., **DO NOT** create a secondary segment.

Incorrect

67. JOHN	▼ Speech	▼ 191.34 - 194.06	⋮	
The kids just so excited to this <overlap>show and I'd</overlap> told them the joke early.				
68.				
BRAD	▼ Speech	▼ 191.39 - 194.01	▶	⋮
<overlap>[laugh] [cough]</overlap>				

Correct

67. JOHN	▼ Speech	▼ 191.34 - 194.06	⋮	
The kids just so excited to this [laugh] [cough] show and I'd told them the joke early.				

- Secondary segment must be tight around speech. [no-speech] tags should not be used within the secondary segment.
 - DO NOT** add [no-speech] tags before or after the overlap text.
 - DO NOT** enclose the overlap text in [no-speech] tags.

Incorrect

47. JOHN	▼ Speech	▼ 161.22 - 163.78	⋮		9/16/22, 10:27 AM
Sorry, something came up. [other-speech] #uh I tried texting you. Did you <overlap>not get my text message that</overlap> I sent around ten <initial>p.m.</initial>?					
BRAD	▼ Speech	▼ 161.27 - 163.73	▶	⋮	10/07/2022, 3:33 PM
[no-speech] <overlap>#uh, I don't think I did. Let me check.</overlap> [no-speech]					

Correct

47. JOHN	▼ Speech	▼ 161.22 - 163.78	⋮		9/16/22, 10:27 AM
Sorry, something came up. [other-speech] #uh I tried texting you. Did you <overlap>not get my text message that</overlap> I sent around ten <initial>p.m.</initial>?					
BRAD	▼ Speech	▼ 161.27 - 163.73	▶	⋮	10/07/2022, 3:35 PM
<overlap>#uh, I don't think I did. Let me check.</overlap>					